A FREE WORKBOOK FROM THERAPY FOR EVERY BODY

Meeting Your Parts

An Internal Family Systems starter workbook

Everyone has parts. There's the part of you that plans ahead, the part that wants to hide under a blanket, the part that snaps when you're tired, and the part that still feels small sometimes. Internal Family Systems (IFS) invites you to get curious about these parts instead of fighting them. Underneath them all is your **Self**: the calm, curious, compassionate core of who you are.

These four worksheets are a gentle place to start. Take your time. There are no wrong answers here.

WHAT'S INSIDE

1. Parts Inventory
2. Parts Map
3. Unblending Checklist
4. Self Energy and the 8 Cs Check-In

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to Use This Workbook

- **Go slowly.** One worksheet in a sitting is plenty. Parts tend to open up when they don't feel rushed.
- **Fill it in your way.** Type right into the boxes on screen, or print it and write by hand.
- **Name parts however you like.** "The Worrier," "Little Me," and "The Fixer" are all great names.
- **Thank your parts.** Even the ones that cause trouble are usually trying to help you in some way.

A quick guide to parts

Managers

Try to keep you safe ahead of time.

Planning, pleasing, perfecting, controlling, criticizing, staying busy.

Firefighters

Jump in fast when pain breaks through.

Numbing, scrolling, bingeing, raging, shutting down, escaping.

Exiles

Younger parts that carry hurt, fear, or shame.

Protectors work hard to keep these parts out of view.

IFS sees every part as having a positive intention, even when its methods are hard on you. The goal is never to get rid of a part. It is to understand it well enough that it can relax.

Take care of yourself

This workbook is about getting to know your protective parts, not digging into painful memories. If you notice strong emotion, numbness, spacing out, or a part that feels very young and hurt, that's a signal to pause. Put your feet on the floor, look around the room, and name five things you can see. You can always come back another day, and this deeper work is often best done alongside a therapist.

This workbook is for education and self reflection. It isn't a substitute for therapy. If you're in crisis, call or text **988**, or call **911**.

WORKSHEET 1

Parts Inventory

Start by noticing who shows up. Think of a recent moment that stirred you up, or simply turn your attention inward and see which part steps forward first. A part might show up as a thought, an image, an urge, or a feeling in your body. All of those count. Fill in one card per part. Five or six is a lovely start, and one or two is fine too.

PART 1

What I call this part

Where I feel it in my body

What brings it out

What it's trying to do for me

Its main feeling and age

How it gets my attention

This part might be a: ☐ Manager ☐ Firefighter ☐ Not sure yet

PART 2

What I call this part

Where I feel it in my body

What brings it out

What it's trying to do for me

Its main feeling and age

How it gets my attention

This part might be a: ☐ Manager ☐ Firefighter ☐ Not sure yet

PART 3

What I call this part

Where I feel it in my body

What brings it out

What it's trying to do for me

Its main feeling and age

How it gets my attention

This part might be a: ☐ Manager ☐ Firefighter ☐ Not sure yet

Parts Inventory, continued

PART 4

What I call this part

Where I feel it in my body

What brings it out

What it's trying to do for me

Its main feeling and age

How it gets my attention

This part might be a: ☐ Manager ☐ Firefighter ☐ Not sure yet

PART 5

What I call this part

Where I feel it in my body

What brings it out

What it's trying to do for me

Its main feeling and age

How it gets my attention

This part might be a: ☐ Manager ☐ Firefighter ☐ Not sure yet

PART 6

What I call this part

Where I feel it in my body

What brings it out

What it's trying to do for me

Its main feeling and age

How it gets my attention

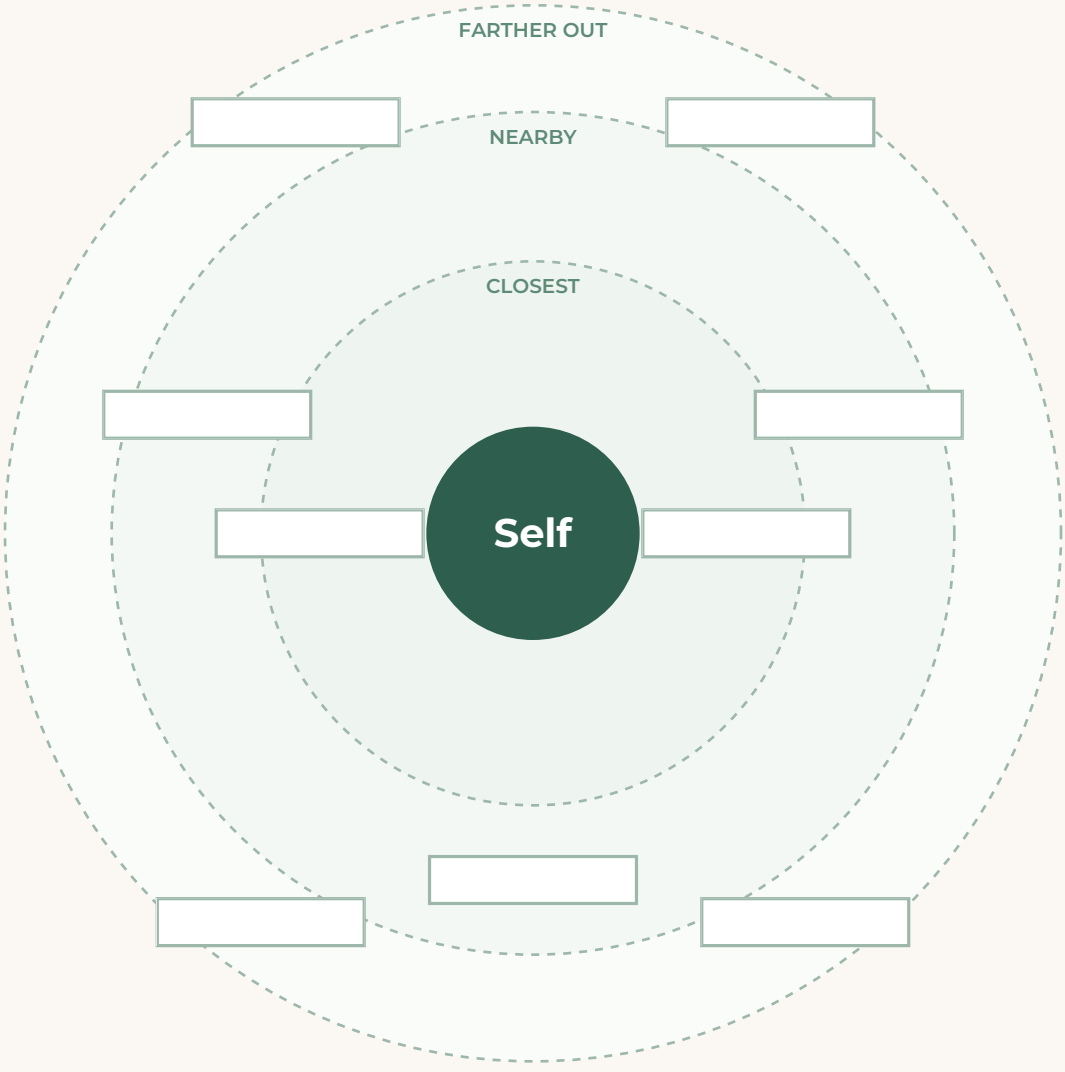
This part might be a: ☐ Manager ☐ Firefighter ☐ Not sure yet

Anything else I noticed

WORKSHEET 2

Parts Map

Now place your parts around your Self. Write each part's name in a box. Put the parts that feel closest, loudest, or most in charge in the inner ring, and quieter or more distant parts farther out. If you print this page, try drawing arrows between parts that team up or clash.



Which part takes up the most space right now?

Which parts seem to work together, and which ones clash?

Is there a part I'd like to understand better? What would I ask it?

WORKSHEET 3

Unblending Checklist

When a part is **blended**, its feelings feel like all of you: "I'm furious" instead of "a part of me is furious." Unblending means giving that part a little room so your Self can be there too. It doesn't mean pushing the part away.

Signs a part may be blended

- [ ] My feelings seem much bigger than the moment
- [ ] I'm thinking in always and never
- [ ] My body feels tense, hot, heavy, or buzzing
- [ ] I feel an urgent need to act, fix, or escape
- [ ] I can't get curious about anyone's point of view, even my own
- [ ] I hear a harsh or very familiar voice in my head

Steps to try

1. **Notice it.** What am I feeling, and where does it live in my body?

2. **Name it as a part.** Try finishing the sentence: "A part of me feels..."

3. **Ask for a little space.** Gently ask, "Would you be willing to step back a bit so I can get to know you?" What happened when I asked?

4. **Check how I feel toward it.** If I feel annoyed, scared, or want it gone, that's another part. I can ask that part for some room too. How do I feel toward this part now?

5. **Get curious.** Ask the part, "What do you want me to know?" What did it say or show me?

6. **Thank it.** - [ ] I thanked my part for what it's trying to do for me.

Pause and ground first if you feel flooded, numb, or far away, or if the part won't step back. That's okay. It may need to know it's safe before it can relax. Try a few slow breaths, feel your feet on the floor, or name what you can see around you.

WORKSHEET 4

Self Energy and the 8 Cs Check-In

Dr. Richard Schwartz, who developed IFS, describes Self energy through eight Cs. Everyone has a Self, even when parts are crowding it out. Rate how much of each C you can feel right now, from **1** (barely there) to **10** (fully present). Check in weekly or every other week and notice how it shifts.

THE C	WHAT IT CAN FEEL LIKE	CHECK-INS 1	2	3	4
Date					
Calm	A settled body and mind, even when things are hard				
Curiosity	Wanting to understand instead of judge				
Clarity	Seeing a situation as it is, without distortion				
Compassion	Warmth and care toward myself and others				
Confidence	Trust that I can handle what comes				
Courage	Willingness to face hard things				
Creativity	Openness to new ideas and possibilities				
Connectedness	Feeling linked to myself, others, and the world				

Which C felt easiest to reach? When do I notice it most?

Which C felt hardest? What part might be standing in front of it?

A low score is information, not failure. It usually means a protective part is working hard. Get curious about what it needs in order to relax a little.

NEXT STEPS

Going Deeper, Together

Parts work can be powerful on your own, and it often goes further with a guide. At Therapy for Every Body, our therapists offer IFS therapy for adults and teens. A therapist can help you approach the more tender parts of your system safely, at a pace that feels right for you.

We're a gender affirming, family friendly group practice offering therapy in person and by telehealth throughout California. We're in network with Cigna and Aetna.

SCHEDULE A FREE CONSULTATION

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A note to my parts

What I want my parts to know after doing this work

Internal Family Systems (IFS) was developed by Richard C. Schwartz, PhD. This workbook is an educational resource created by Therapy for Every Body and is not affiliated with or endorsed by IFS Institute. It is not a substitute for professional care. If you're in crisis, call or text 988, or call 911.
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